

**INSTITUTIONAL
INVESTOR**



9th Annual Retirement Plan Advisor Summit - Central

March 24 - 25, 2026
Four Seasons Hotel
Chicago, IL

RPA Institute



Longevity, Returns, and Resilience: How Are Advisors Approaching an Aging World?

2026 Advisory Board

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Kevin Mahoney, *Managing Director, The Mahoney Group*, **Raymond James**

Francesca Federico, *Co-Founder & President*, **Twelve Points Retirement Advisors**

Agenda

Tuesday, March 24, 2026

7:45-8:45**Registration and Breakfast***Ballroom Foyer and Ballroom C*

8:45-9:00**Introduction, Chair's Welcome & Interactive Polling Session***Ballroom AB***Presented by:**

Cynthia Huynh, *Executive Director, Head of Investor Relations, Wealth Management, Institutional Investor*

Conference Chairs:

Jeff Cullen, *CEO, Co-Founder, Strategic Retirement Partners*

Bill Thompson, *National Retirement & Wealth Sales Officer, Marsh McLennan Agency*

What are the investment issues, concerns, and priorities of your peers? What strategies and goals are front of mind for this group of industry stakeholders? In this opening session attendees will be polled on several high-interest topics using an interactive electronic response system. By doing this, we will provide all attendees with useful and unique insights to be considered throughout the rest of the conference.

9:00-9:45**The Boomer Retirement Cliff: How Should Advisors Approach a Historical Wealth Transition and Demographic Shift?***Ballroom AB***Moderator:**

Stephen Welch, *Managing Partner, Crownmark Wealth Advisors*

Panelists:

Karen Casillas, *Vice President, CAPTRUST Financial Advisors*

Bob Cohen, *CIO, ProManage*

Michael Shea, *President, Pension & Benefits Associates, Inc.*

Andy Reed, *Head of Behavioral Economics Research, Vanguard*

With the retirement of the biggest demographic group in history well under way (and only accelerating), the retirement landscape will be forever changed as boomers sell and unload their investments to fund their retirement. Advisors are in a pole position in overseeing and guiding this transition. What are the opportunities and pitfalls? What should advisors be on the lookout for? Join our opening panel as we discuss this historical event in progress.

9:45-10:30**The Coming Risks of an Increasingly Consolidated Industry***Ballroom AB***Moderator:**

Kristina Keck, *Area Senior Vice President, Arthur J. Gallagher & Co.*

Panelists:

Matt Cellini, *Partner, Practice Leader, Greenspring Advisors*

Kristen Donovan, QKA, CPFA, AIF, *Director of Retirement Solutions, Focus Financial Partners*

Peter Barron, *Managing Director, Global Platforms, MFS Investment Management*

Jeff Cullen, *CEO, Co-Founder, Strategic Retirement Partners*

As more and more PE firms find opportunities in rolling up advisory firms, a historically fragmented industry is becoming increasingly concentrated. Risks also rise with more and more firms being consolidated and rolled up. Our closing panel of day one will look at these potential risks, what they think the market will look like in the years ahead, and how independent advisors are reacting to a seemingly unstoppable force.

10:30-11:10

Workshop A: Beyond the Intro – Getting Comfortable with Private Markets

State A

Presented by:

James Ryder, CFA, *Vice President, Defined Contribution Investment Strategy,*

State Street Investment Management

Lauren Top, *Vice President, Regional Consultant,*

State Street Investment Management

As consideration for private markets in defined contribution plans continues to grow, questions shift to *how* to implement strategies responsibly and effectively. This session explores considerations around transparency, liquidity, and valuation, and what plan sponsors need to feel confident moving forward. Join us for a practical, forward-looking discussion designed to close knowledge gaps and help you take the next step on your private-markets journey.

Workshop B

State B

Panelists:

Senior representative, **401GO**

11:10-11:35**Coffee Break**

Ballroom Foyer

11:35-12:15

Workshop C: The Evolving 401K Advice Landscape

State A

Moderator:

Joshua Schwartz, AIF, *CEO, Retirement Plan Advisors*

Panelists:

Jerry Bonnabeau, *Head of Defined Contribution Partnerships, Pontera*

Senior Representative, **Vanguard**

Workshop D: Leveraging Large-Market PEPs to Win and Protect Key Clients

State B

Moderator:

Danny Kling, *Divisional Vice President, Transamerica*

Panelists:

Todd Timmerman, *Founder & Managing Director, Retirement Plan Analytics*

Matt Cellini, *Partner & Practice Lead, Greenspring Advisors*

As the Pooled Employer Plan (PEP) landscape rapidly evolves, consultants are turning to institutional-level PEP solutions to compete effectively in the large-market space. This panel explores how advisors are using these strategies both to win larger plans and to strengthen retention by providing scalable, future-ready solutions for existing clients.

12:15-1:00

Build It and They Won't Come? How Should Advisors and Providers Up Their Retirement Income Adoption Game

Ballroom AB

Moderator:

Brendan McCarthy, *Head of Nuveen Retirement Investing*, **Nuveen**

Panelists:

Philip Chao, *Principal, Chief Investment Officer*, **Experiential Wealth**

David Bazzel, *Defined Contribution Product Specialist – Retirement Solutions*, **Nationwide**

Steven Scott, *CEO*, **Retirement Solution Group**

Derek Fiorenza, *COO/CCO*, **Summit Group Retirement Planners, Inc.**

After the years and years of discussing retirement income solutions, the industry is still grappling with the need for more widespread adoption of these solutions by the masses. What is still holding back the masses from utilizing these options? Are industry stakeholders doing their best in providing a true client-first and client-centric experience when it comes to retirement income? What has and hasn't been working in the income space the past few years?

1:00-2:15

Lunch

Ballroom C

2:15-2:50

TBD

Ballroom AB

Presented by:

To be confirmed.

2:50-3:10

Personalization in the Age of Global Aging

Ballroom AB

Presented by:

Loukas Stephens, *VP - U.S. Defined Contribution*, **Fisher Investments**

3:10-3:50

Afternoon Think Tanks

Ballroom C

Plan Forfeiture: The Next Litigation Front Line

Discussion Leaders:

Michael Sasso, *Principal*, **CAPTRUST**

Adam Greetis, *Partner, Employee Benefits*, **Seyfarth & Shaw**

The Legal Concerns That Come with Utilizing AI**Discussion Leaders:**

To be confirmed.

Benchmarking Your TDF Line-ups**Discussion Leaders:**

Arley Reyes, CFA, *Director, Investment Strategy, Multi-Asset Strategies & Solutions, BlackRock*

Dissecting the Conflict of Interest Between Wealth and Retirement Advisory**Discussion Leaders:**

Will Hackler, *Director of Retirement Plans, Integrated Partners*

How Are Advisors Working with Older Participants in a Digital-Only World?**Discussion Leaders:**

Michael Kushner, *Director of New Relationship Development, Advanced Strategies Group*

Designing and Nurturing a Unique Culture for Your Firm**Discussion Leaders:**

Michelle Cannan, *Managing Director, Head of Company Retirement Plan Services, Modern Wealth Management*

3:50-4:15**Coffee Break**

Ballroom Foyer

4:15-4:50**Principal Protection for Participants Against a World in Flux**

Ballroom AB

Moderator:

Todd Howard, *National Sales Director | Stable Value, MassMutual Stable Value Investments*

Panelists:

Jennifer Doss, *DC Practice Leader, CAPTRUST*

Todd Stewart, *Managing Director, SageView Advisory Group*

Todd Gurvis, *Vice President of Wealth Management, Trilogy Financial*

This panel will discuss some of the unique challenges and opportunities that the near-retirement participant segment faces, especially in the face of hypothetical and uncertain market conditions. Money market investments, stable value options, and certain retirement income strategies are all components to solidifying principal protection for this group – hear the pros and cons on all of these different options, and what advisors and providers can work on together to ensuring a safe retirement.

4:50-5:30**From Complexity to Clarity: A Measured Approach to Evaluating Private Investments and Other Non-Traditional Investments in DC Plans**

Ballroom AB

Moderator:

Daniel Oldroyd, *Portfolio Manager and Target Date Strategies, J.P. Morgan Asset Management*

Panelists:

Myles Meserve, CFA, CAIA, *Vice President*, **Goldman Sachs Asset Management**

Brian Collins, *Chief Investment Officer*, **HUB International – Wealth & Retirement**

Chris Braccia, *Chief Investment Officer*, **Manhattan Ridge Advisors**

As alternative investments become more prominent in the retirement industry, advisors and providers face new opportunities and challenges. With supportive macroeconomic and regulatory trends, the industry is poised for further expansion into this space. However, widespread adoption of new solutions has historically been gradual. To help ensure success, how can advisors and providers collaborate to determine what is appropriate for plan participants? What communication and engagement strategies are most effective? And how are advisors conducting due diligence to best serve their clients?

5:40

Cocktail and Dinner Reception at the Untitled Supper Club

Wednesday, March 25, 2026

8:00-8:45**Breakfast Think Tanks***Ballroom C***Pricing the Cross-Selling of Health and Wellness Products****Discussion Leaders:**

Holly Turner, Retirement Plan Consultant, **Bolton Investments** (pending)

What Are Your Ideas for Improving the Retirement UX?**Discussion Leaders:**

Steven Scott, *CEO*, **Retirement Solution Group**

How Far Can Personalization Go in the Age of AI?**Discussion Leaders:**

To be confirmed.

Navigating RFPs and the Thorny Issue of Fees**Discussion Leaders:**

Christina Unison, *Managing Director*, **Strategic Retirement Partners**

8:45-8:50**Welcome Back to Day Two***Ballroom AB***Presented by:**

Rip Reeves, *Chief Executive Officer*, **Institutional Investor**

8:50-9:30**Will PEPs Be the Silver Bullet for Smaller Business Plan Adoption, and How Advisors Can Benefit***Ballroom AB***Moderator:**

Virginia Debbink, *Retirement Plan Consultant*, **Three Bell Capital**

Panelists:

Molly Beer, *National Practice Leader Retirement - Defined Contribution*, **Gallagher**

Angie Chen, *Associate Director of Savings and Household Finance*, **Center for Retirement**

Research at Boston College

Christopher Cervantes, *Founder, Managing Partner*, **Valorous Advisors**

As the retirement industry continues its quest on helping small businesses set up plans, PEPs are often touted as a crucial tool – join this panel as we evaluate the growth and evolution of the PEP market, how it's helping coverage, what more is needed on the front, and how advisors should be evaluating and helping their PEP clients.

9:30-10:15**Back to the Basics: Sharing the Practical Use Cases for AI as a Retirement Advisor***Ballroom AB*

Moderator:

Apryl Pope, *Certified Plan Fiduciary Advisor*, **LPL Financial Services**

Panelists:

Kyle Nelson, *Financial Consultant*, **intelligents**

Courtney Shipley, *Chief Planologist*, **Retirement Planology**

The retirement industry has always been ripe for something like the AI disruption, given the early interest in robo-advisors and all the work with regards to personalization. With the recent advent of AI, however, the industry has a much more diverse kit of AI tools at its disposal – but beyond the usage of Copilot and ChatGPT in advisors' daily workflows, what are some of the examples of actual AI utilization in retirement plans and advisory practices? How far can the advent of AI go in this industry?

10:15-10:45
Coffee Break

Ballroom Foyer

10:45-11:30
Managing the Mindsets of the Next Generation of Plan Advisors

Ballroom AB

Moderator:

Josh Ulmer, *Managing Director, Wealth Management, Institutional Consulting Director*, **Graystone Consulting from Morgan Stanley**

Panelists:

John Wilcox, *Partner*, **Mayflower Advisors**

Michelle Cannan, *Managing Director, Head of Company Retirement Plan Services*, **Modern Wealth Management**

Steven Johnian, *Alliance Relationship Manager*, **SFP Wealth**

Developing the next generation of talented and trusted plan advisors for your firms is always the hot topic at industry conferences. More than ever, a changing business model and how the next generation of advisors perceive their relationships with their firms, and how they perceive their career trajectories are becoming radically different from the current generation of RPA leadership. Managing this changed mindset will be crucial as the great transition continues – join our closing panel on day one a much-needed talk.

11:30-12:15
Is DEI Dead?

Ballroom AB

Moderator:

Nicole Corning, *Partner*, **Pathlight Advisors**

Panelists:

Alison Law-Tatko, *Regional Vice President*, **Arthur J. Gallagher & Co.**

Calla Gorman, *VP, Retirement Plan Services*, **Finspire**

The panelists will explore the future relevance of DEI drawing on insights from the annual WIPN research report, demographic trends, and the real life experiences and perspective of our panelists.

12:30
Lunch & Networking with WIPN

Ballroom C

Summit Concludes – See You in Santa Monica!